



Implementation of VoIP is not as important as the fact that it works well

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tion. All this was planned keeping the crossover to the paperless office in mind."

And How They Found A Solution

SVC Bank has a total of 38 branch offices and four extension counters. Of these, 26 are in Mumbai, five in the rest of Maharashtra, 10 in Karnataka and one in Panjim, Goa. A Unicenter Service Desk Network was set up to replace the help desk to assist users with IT-related issues. This solution from Computer Associates morphed the conventional 'help desk' into an all-encompassing operational support group. Accordingly, a broadband backbone, comprising leased lines and ISDN, interconnected all 42 locations.

Existing and upgraded connections were used from DoT and MTNL. As the next step, all the ATMs were connected together using this dedicated link. Last, a major step was taken in the implementation of VoIP telephony.

The interconnecting VoIP network took three months to build. Now, for the past 18 months, most official communication is done using IP phones. These were deployed keeping in mind the infrastructural cost overhead as well as utilisation of available resources.

The deployment of VoIP, says Mankikar, was primarily targeted at significantly decreasing communication costs. Official communication via the standard phone, fax and e-mail proved costly, while on the other hand, there was a considerable amount of idle bandwidth on the 64 Kbps intranet data network.

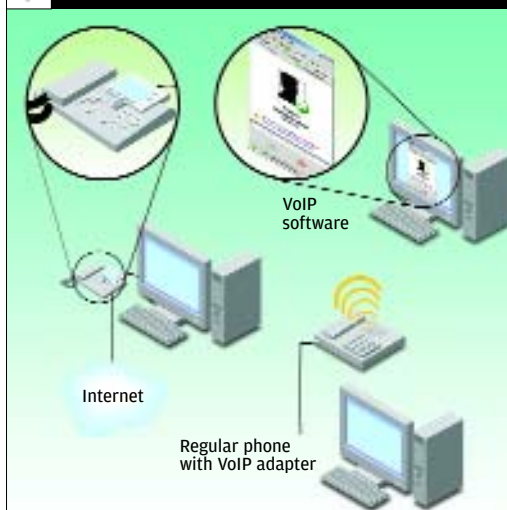
Moving to VoIP meant efficient resource utilisation, while ensuring that telecommunication costs cut down significantly. This could have entailed complications with MTNL; however, the unified network approval took care of that.

Setting up a VoIP network does incur costs. But the benefits more than compensate for the expense. SVC Bank, for instance, shaved Rs 25 lakh off its communications bill.

You can trim such expenditure by using the existing data network for voice data transfers via VoIP, simultaneously ensuring reliability and security. Having voice and data on the same network also means it is fit to be used for branch transactions. Firewalls and IDS protect the intranet. This aside, the data network is separate from the existing network.

The implementation of VoIP was tar-

How VoIP Works



VoIP converts voice signals from a telephone into a digital signal that travels over the Internet. If it's a regular phone number that is dialled, the signal is converted back at the other end.

VoIP also lets you dial directly from a computer. At times, service providers may provide a dial tone for VoIP-enabled phones. If the service assigns a regular phone number, then an individual can call from his or her regular phone into the VoIP set without using special equipment to access the Internet.

geted at ironing out kinks in the decision-making and authorisation process without having to rely on conventional correspondence modes such as e-mail and fax. However, non-written modes of official transaction tend to be problematic, as questions of confidentiality come into the picture.

For example, you need to authenticate a transaction request to the head office and authorisations for branch offices. An e-mail-based system accomplishes this via digital signatures. This can not be achieved through an STD call. VoIP phones however, says Mankikar, can also be used as a locator for employees in responsible positions.

It Takes Time To Deploy And Train

It took three months to deploy the system and another three months to train employees. The training did not coincide with the deployment process and took place independently. Wipro set up all the hardware, the sleek call manager and the Cisco IP7940 phones included. The call managers and the servers reside in a glass room cooled by intelligent air-conditioning systems. VoIP is just a component for internal corporate communications for SVC bank. IP telephony is supplemented by the Microsoft Exchange server.

Apart from handling e-mail and other correspondence, it is also integrated with the call manager, which monitors the various links among the branches and remote offices. If a link is down, it sends e-mails to the concerned authorities in the office and SMSes others.

These e-mails and SMSes are then used to monitor intranet activity for the entire backbone. The records, in the form of e-mails, can also be used to cross-check event logs prepared by HCL Comnet, the company that maintains the data network. The same call manager also

Where Will You Incur Costs

Investments

VoIP telecommunications hardware and software
IP phone sets or soft phones
Network upgrades for possible quality of service and performance upgrades
Implementation labour and professional services
On-going support and administration labour
Support and maintenance contracts
Increased support calls and potential user downtime losses on initial deployment
IT Training
User Training
Write-off, write-down and disposal costs for existing telecommunication assets

Risk Potential

Quality of service/performance
User training and adoption
Administration and support skill levels and resources
Proprietary vs. open systems interoperability

Source

http://searchcio.techtarget.com/ateQuestionResponse/0,289625,sid19_cid558148_tax292624,0.0.html